United States Department of Agriculture

Food and Nutrition Administration

5601 Sunnyside Avenue

Beltsville, MD 20705

September 11, 2026

Peter Kastner
20 Seawatch Drive
Savannah, GA 31411

RE: **Final Response for FOIA Tracking Number 2026-FNS-07231-F**

Dear Mr. Kastner:

This letter is in response to the Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) request, dated July 28, 2026. We received your request on that date and assigned it FOIA Tracking Number 2026-FNS-07231-F.

In your request, you sought the following:

Records concerning the State of Florida's integrated public assistance eligibility system (the "FLORIDA system"), procured by the Florida Department of Health and Rehabilitative Services under Request for Proposal 88-74-BC issued May 20, 1988 and contracted to EDS Federal Corporation on May 15, 1989, for the period January 1, 1986 through December 31, 1996:

1. All Advance Planning Documents and APD Updates submitted by Florida to FNS under 7 C.F.R. § 277.18 for the FLORIDA system, with all attachments — including the requirements analysis, the alternatives analysis, the cost-benefit analysis, the implementation plan, and any acceptance criteria, performance standards, system capacity projections, or response-time specifications contained in or attached to those submissions.

2. All FNS approval, conditional approval, disapproval, or suspension letters responding to those submissions, and any conditions imposed relating to system performance.

3. All FNS reviews, assessments, functional demonstrations, certification reviews, or post-implementation reports concerning FLORIDA system functionality, capacity, or performance.

4. Records concerning food stamp payment error-rate liabilities assessed against Florida for fiscal years 1989–90 through 1994–95 — including the FY1990–91 assessment reported at approximately $5 million against an error rate of 10.89% versus a 10.31% national average — together with any state appeals, waivers, good-cause claims, reinvestment agreements, or settlements.

5. Any correspondence between FNS and Florida HRS or the Florida Department of Children and Families attributing error-rate performance, benefit issuance failures, or duplicate or deceased-recipient payments to the FLORIDA system.

6. Any USDA Office of Inspector General audit or investigative reports concerning Florida's food stamp automation or the FLORIDA system.

Your request has been processed under the FOIA, 5 U.S.C. § 552. A search for responsive records was conducted by the applicable FNA Program Offices. Please be advised that no responsive records were found.

You may submit your request to the applicable state agency in Florida, which would technically be the place where the records you are seeking originated and are maintained.

This concludes our response to you. You have the right to appeal this determination. You may appeal by writing to the Administrator, Food and Nutrition Administration, at 5601 Sunnyside Avenue, Beltsville, MD 20705, or by email to SM.fn.APPEALS-FNA@usda.gov within 90 calendar days from the date of this letter. The phrase "FOIA APPEAL" should be placed in capital letters on the front of the envelope or in the subject of the email containing the appeal.

The appeal letter should include the **FOIA Tracking Number** listed above, a copy of the original request, FNA FOIA's response to your original request, and a statement explaining the basis of your appeal.

You may seek dispute resolution services from FNA's FOIA Public Liaison, Ms. Evlyn Hearne. Ms. Hearne may be contacted by telephone at (703) 305-2179 or e-mail at SM.fn.LIAISONS-FNA@usda.gov.

You also have the option to seek dispute resolution assistance from the Office of Government Information Services (OGIS). The Open Government Act of 2007 created OGIS within the National Archives and Records Administration when Congress amended the FOIA. OGIS provides mediation of FOIA disputes between appellants and Federal agencies. Participation in mediation does not affect your right to judicial review. Contact information for OGIS can be located at: www.Archives.gov/ogis.

If you have any questions pertaining to this matter you may contact us by email at FOIA-FNA@usda.gov. Please refer to FOIA Tracking Number **2026-FNS-07231-F** in any future correspondence.

Sincerely,

Kevin Lynch

Kevin Lynch
FNA FOIA Officer